

Mr. Sandeep Khollam
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Career Objective

To synergize my abilities and qualities and continuously acquire knowledge, education and experience to build a successful career in a professional organization

Summary of Skills and Experience

- A professional with 17+ years of experience in versatile BPO operations both Voice and Back Office in Delivering Customer Services
 - Cross-Functional Team Player with excellent interpersonal, communication, analytical and planning skills with proven abilities in People management and Client relationship management
 - Primary Operational goals & objectives include enhancing Customer Satisfaction Survey, improving Financial Performance, enhancing Business Process Performance and improving People Excellence
 - Proven track record of successfully managing Business transformation and migration through a determined and focused approach till implementation.
 - Managing team functions viz. Manpower planning, Recruitment & selection, Induction, Performance appraisal, Training, Transition etc
- Strong Domain Expertise of handling **Airline Operations and Reservation systems (GDS)**, core competencies in both Voice operations, Reservations and Ticketing.
- Strong Domain of **KYC Verification** based on AI and ML. Core competencies in Non-Voice Operations, Fraud Detection and Document Verification.
- Certified in ITIL Foundation and also in IATA/UFTAA Foundation.
- Certified in Six Sigma Black Belt program.

Experience

1. **WNS Global Services Pvt. Ltd.** : April 2023 – Till now
Sr. Group Manager - Operations : April 2023 – Till now
2. **Ascendion Inc..** : September 2022– April 2023
Associate Director - Operations : September 2022 – April 2023
3. **WNS Global Services Pvt. Ltd.** : August 2019 – September 2022
Sr. Group Manager - Operations : August 2019 – September 2022
4. **Fareportal India Pvt. Ltd** : March 2016 – August'19
Team Manager - Operations: March 2016 – August 2019

5. **First Cry Pvt. Ltd** : October 2015 – March 2016

Assistant Manager – Operations : October 2015 – March 2016

6. **WNS Global Services Pvt. Ltd** : December 2014 – October 2015

Assistant Manager – Operations : December 2014 – October 2015

7. **Wipro BPO**: June 2007 – December 2014

Associate : June 2007 – February 2009

Team Leader: February 2009 - December 2014

Processes

Sr. Group Manager – Operations (KYC Verification – AI & ML based Identity Validation) WNS Global Services Pvt. Ltd., April 2023 till now

Account Handled: Handling World's Biggest UK Based Identity Verification company - Back office Operations including AI & ML based KYC Verification, Fraud Detection & Data Extraction of Documents.

Role and Responsibility:

- Responsible for recruiting, training, managing and monitoring agents so that they have the skills and knowledge to meet goals and objectives of the process.
- Driving operational excellence set as a standard by the Organization and adhering to the standard operating procedures.
- Liaise between the Leadership and the Organization to cascade Organizational strategies and goals.
- Lead small departmental projects or initiatives that support departmental goals.
- Develop contingency strategies & plan for staffing changes.
- Accountable for the Quality standards reported by the Quality & Monitoring team
- Presenting the executive report to the Management highlighting the performance as well as lack of performance of various metrics/goals of the Business Unit
- Participate on process improvement initiatives for business unit, actively participate in process transitions, preparing MSA, SOW and other legal documents pertaining to ramp ups or ramp downs
- Identify causes for non-attainment of SLAs, develop solutions and execute the same.
- Develop models on incentive structures for R&R.
- Capacity Utilization – Trends, Attrition, Project Ramp Ups & metrics.
- WFM Management Service Levels, Work Prioritization Strategies, Productivity (Reducing Shrinkages & Tracking AHT)
- Provide various timely reporting to Business Head on production, overtime, FTEs, monthly invoices, revenue attainment, preparing SOW, MSAs & Change Orders etc.
- Build strong relationship with business unit leaders & daily touch point with clients on key performance areas.
- Business Reviews – QBR / MBR / WBR with the clients on performance.
- Conduct appraisals, reviews, incentives, reward & recognition in the Process
- Manage FTEs, TLs, AMs and Manager levels to meet critical performance metrics & business SLAs.

- Liaise with other internal support functions including HR, IT & Facilities to address and take required to run smooth operations.

**Associate Director – Operations (US based Recruitment Process Outsourcing)
Ascension Inc. (Formerly Know as Collabera Services Pvt. Ltd..., September
2022 till April 2023**

Account Handled: Support the Business vertical at Global Delivery Center as a Talent Head

Role and Responsibility:

- Formulate and execute key business initiatives at GDC level within the assigned department
- Manage the overall compensation framework including salary appraisals, incentive and bonus plans, IUP etc.
- Formulate and oversee the implementation of rewards and recognition framework including various contests, POBs etc. within the assigned budget
- Develop the people plan and long-term roadmap for the assigned area in conjunction with the business plan considering the overall business dynamics
- Tactically handle transactions pertaining to workforce planning, recruitment, compensation, on boarding, termination etc.
- Drive employee engagement activities to drive better productivity of the team to be more focused
- Conceptualize & seamlessly implement strategies to retain, develop and motivate people for achieving their highest potential by collaborating with middle management.
- Lead the succession planning exercise for critical positions & groom the high potential talent in partnership with the L&OD Team.
- Effectively handle all employee communications within the assigned area
- Accountable for taking decisions pertaining to key personnel aspects like yearly manpower planning, hiring, promotions, PEP enforcement etc.
- Key Decision maker for assigned department(s) and work on driving key strategic initiatives by partnering with senior stakeholders in each business unit
- Accountable for creating the KRA and ensuring team hits the required productivity

**Sr. Group Manager – Operations (KYC Verification – AI & ML based Identity Validation)
WNS Global Services Pvt. Ltd., August 2019 till September 2022**

Account Handled: Handling World's Biggest UK Based Identity Verification company - Back office Operations including AI & ML based KYC Verification, Fraud Detection & Data Extraction of Documents.

Role and Responsibility:

- Responsible for recruiting, training, managing and monitoring agents so that they have the skills and knowledge to meet goals and objectives of the process.
- Driving operational excellence set as a standard by the Organization and adhering to the standard operating procedures.
- Liaise between the Leadership and the Organization to cascade Organizational strategies and goals.
- Lead small departmental projects or initiatives that support departmental goals.
- Develop contingency strategies & plan for staffing changes.
- Accountable for the Quality standards reported by the Quality & Monitoring team
- Presenting the executive report to the Management highlighting the performance as well

as lack of performance of various metrics/goals of the Business Unit

- Participate on process improvement initiatives for business unit, actively participate in process transitions, preparing MSA, SOW and other legal documents pertaining to ramp ups or ramp downs
- Identify causes for non-attainment of SLAs, develop solutions and execute the same.
- Develop models on incentive structures for R&R.
- Capacity Utilization – Trends, Attrition, Project Ramp Ups & metrics.
- WFM Management Service Levels, Work Prioritization Strategies, Productivity (Reducing Shrinkages & Tracking AHT)
- Provide various timely reporting to Business Head on production, overtime, FTEs, monthly invoices, revenue attainment, preparing SOW, MSAs & Change Orders etc.
- Build strong relationship with business unit leaders & daily touch point with clients on key performance areas.
- Business Reviews – QBR / MBR / WBR with the clients on performance.
- Conduct appraisals, reviews, incentives, reward & recognition in the Process
- Manage FTEs, TLs, AMs and Manager levels to meet critical performance metrics & business SLAs.
- Liaise with other internal support functions including HR, IT & Facilities to address and take required to run smooth operations.

Team Manager – Operations (Airlines – Online Travel Agency)
Fareportal India Pvt Ltd, March 2016 to August 2019

Account Handled: Handled the Exchange Team & Customer Services business for clients based in the U.S, U.K & World-wide markets

Role and Responsibility:

- Responsible for recruiting, training, managing and monitoring agents so that they have the skills and knowledge to meet Sales goals and Customer Service objectives
- Driving operational excellence set as a standard by the Organization and adhering to the standard operating procedures
- Monitoring overall functioning of processes, identifying improvement areas and implementing adequate measures to maximize Organizational revenues
- Monitoring utilization of existing resources and manpower, planning targets, monitoring performance and achievement of overall targets on a daily, weekly and monthly basis
- Support and enforce First Call Resolution strategy across Operations
- Liaise between the Leadership and the Organization to cascade Organizational strategies and goals
- Develop and sustain Customer Service excellence including measurement and continuous improvement
- Accountable for the Quality standards reported by the Quality & Monitoring team
- Presenting the executive report to the Management highlighting the performance as well as lack of performance of various metrics/goals of the Business Unit
- Conduct appraisals, reviews, incentives, reward & recognition in the Process

Assistant Manager - Operations (E-Commerce – Online Store for Baby Products)
Firstcry Pvt. Ltd., October 2015 – March 2016

Account Handled: Handled India's Biggest Online Store for Baby Products - Front office Operations - Voice Call Centre.

Role and Responsibility:

- Responsible for managing Pune site day- to-day Operations, lead client engagements, ensuring consistent service delivery for inbound voice operations.
- Meet or Exceed targets around CPM, SLA's & KPI's to focus on continuous improvement in overall Business Process Performance
- Meet or Exceed targets around attrition/retention, unscheduled absenteeism & shrinkage to focus on continuous improvement in People Excellence
- Responsible for transition, planning & execution of Retail Transformation (RT) Readiness, Go-live, post-implementation & Stabilization
- Promote team work and responsiveness of Manager in their areas of responsibility through support and coaching. Hold regularly scheduled one-on-ones with each Manager to assist in associate development and career planning
- Close alliance with the top management to deliver strategic operational challenges, Service Delivery and formulating and implementing strategies for ensuring client satisfaction and business growth
- Leading, mentoring & monitoring the performance of team members to ensure efficiency in process operations and meeting of individual & group targets/goals
- Strong delivery and training methodologies along with constant outlier management programmes for achieving client metrics primarily being CSAT, DSAT, FCR, Service Levels, AHT, TAT, Quality (GRR =<5%) to name a few along with complete knowledge of the SOW as part of the MSA

Assistant Manager - Operations (Airlines – Online Travel Agency)

WNS Global Services Pvt. Ltd., December 2014 – October 2015

Account Handled: Handled UK Based Online Travel Agency - Front office Operations including Reservation systems, Front office Voice Call Centre, Space Control, Reservations on GDS

Role and Responsibility:

- Performance Management of Lead Coaches through various performance management tools.
- People Management & controlling attrition through various activities & initiatives
- Accounted for the productivity for the process (60 FTEs) which included Average handling time / Transaction productivity / Staffing adherence and Quality for my individual Unit and planning on the Manpower and Hiring for the Process
- Trained TLs on varied subjects like AVAYA, IEX, NICE, Internal Reporting Software's, Company Policies and Appraisal Procedures
- Be active participant to address & resolve complaints received through Blogs or DOTs.
- Weekly & Monthly performance reviews with the Ops Managers / Sr. Managers.

Achievements

- Successfully handled voice operations comprising of a team of 60+ agents and Leadership
- Received kudos from the clients on overall process Analysis and Performance of the "customer service" LOB
- Recognized and Rewarded by the WNS HR team for successfully driving the Employee Referral Program in the Process... Top 3 contributing Process in employee referral hiring's across the site.

Team Leader – Operations (Airlines- Reservations & Web Support)
WIPRO BPS, June 2007 to December 2014

Account Handled: Handled US Based Largest Airline - Front office Operations including Reservation systems, Front office Voice Call Centre, Space Control, Reservations on GDS, Web Support.

- Have proficient knowledge of various Airline Solution Systems like Passenger Reservation Booking Systems, Inventory Systems & Frequent Flyer System etc.

Role and Responsibility:

- Performance Management of Associates through various performance management tools.
- People Management & controlling attrition through various activities & initiatives
- Accounted for the productivity for the process (30 FTEs) which included Average handling time / Transaction productivity / CSAT / Staffing adherence and Quality for my individual team.
- Trained New hires & newly promoted SMEs for the web-support LOB and release their Quality and Certification Reports.
- Be active participant to address & resolve complaints received through Blogs or DOTs.
- Weekly & Monthly performance reviews with the Ops Managers / Sr. Managers.
- Attend TTT Sessions, Calibration Activities & Client Conference Calls and take refresher sessions for all the team members from web support LOB.
- BQ Management for the LOB and successfully completed Lean Project to improve CSAT scores for the business unit.
- Responsible to run the backend work (a Queue which was working on Airline Reservation) and review the performance on a weekly basis with the client over the conference call.

Overseas Assignments

- Was given an opportunity to lead a team to Philippines in January.2014 to set a new office for United Airlines. I was responsible for Training, Certifications, mentoring Team Leads to transfer knowledge and set the operations.

Key Achievements / Highlights

- Increase in the billable FTE count from 225 FTEs to 650 FTEs in last 18 months without a single ramp down activity ; revenue increased from \$2.3mn to \$6.7mn
- Inception of two new sites, Colombo & Vizag which grew to a total billable FTE count of 140 & 225 FTE in < 12 months
- Addition of two new LOBs, Facial Recognition Team and Trial (POCs of Prospect Customers) with a total FTE count of 40 FTE; Successfully on-boarded some of the world's largest financial institutions
- Successfully implemented the integration of WNS' learning platform with client's knowledgebase platform to provide self-learning facilities to all the team members; reduced the involvement of trainers to conduct refresher trainings/ briefing sessions for new updates and system changes
- Addition of new LOB with a potential of 500 billable FTE at Nashik and a new site Indore; SOW & MSA sign off completed in April 2022; Go-live with 50 FTEs at Nashik
- Annualized attrition at 32% across all the locations for the last 2 years with the introduction of various people management / reward & recognition techniques; seven employees got promoted to Team Lead, two employees promoted to Deputy Manager, one employee promoted to operations manager & multiple employees promoted as SMEs, Trainers, QAs

- Successfully established a WFM & MIS team for the account with a total team size 10 team members
- Completed Green Belt Project to reduce False Acceptance Rate (Missed Fraud %) from 2.75% to current 1.25%; this helped to reduce client escalations & incorrect flag % leading to less repeat volume of the same customers resulting into improve customer satisfaction
- Identification of fraud rings to help the AI system to capture sophisticated frauds; helped other vendors to improve their fraud accuracy with the help of this initiative
- Implementation of Power BI Dashboards to capture yearly / monthly / weekly productivity & AHT trends along with the Quality Dashboards at an enterprise, location & team level

Educational Qualifications

Passed Bachelor of Commerce (Degree) Examination in March'15 securing a First Class– Chhattisgarh University

Professional Qualifications

Successfully completed a course in ITIL – Foundation certified by APMG – International in February 2015

Basic IATA Fares Training conducted by Airline Financial Support Services Pvt. Ltd

Successfully completed the I.A.T.A Standard Examination in March 2010

Internal Certifications

Successfully completed the Black Belt & Lean Training conducted by Wipro Ltd.

Attended various in-house trainings at Wipro on Managerial Effectiveness Program, Finance for Non-Finance, Leadership Development ...

References

On request

Mr. Sandeep Kholam.